

Birth

- A. J. Cronin

• *BIRTH is the story of a doctor, just a fresher, who handles a complicated child delivery case in the most admirable way and brings back life in a dead born child.*

• *In doing so he applies his medical text book knowledge as well as determination. The story expresses the anxiety, dedication towards profession and gratitude towards God.*

• *Andrew Manson was returning home late night brooding over a disappointing evening with his girl friend, Christine.*

• *It was midnight and when he reached near his house he found a miner, Joe Morgan, awaiting him to attend to his wife immediately. She was expecting their first child after twenty years of marriage.*

• *At the patient's house, Andrew saw that the lady was being attended to by a midwife and Mrs. Morgan, an elderly woman.*

• *It took about two hours when the process of child birth began. Andrew was tired but he had no option to leave the patient.*

• *After about an hour long harsh struggle a child was born towards the dawn. But the child was still born.*

- When Andrew gazed at the lifeless form, he shivered with horror. Then he looked at the mother. She required immediate attention. Andrew was in a dilemma- whom should he attend first: the child or the mother?

- Andrew gave the child to the nurse and turned his attention to the mother who was unconscious. Gradually, her heart strengthened and Andrew could now leave her to attend to the baby.

- He asked about the child. The midwife was thoroughly frightened. Taking this still child, she had dumped it beneath the bed amongst soaked newspaper. He pulled out the child.

- The child was perfectly formed. Andrew could understand that it was a case of suffocation due to lack of oxygen and excess of carbon-dioxide in the blood.

Andrew started giving the necessary treatment. He did not lose heart. The midwife again and again told him that it was a still born child. But Andrew did not heed. He kept on dipping the child's limp body in hot and cold water alternatively.

- After exhaustive efforts, a miracle happened. The child sighed and started crying. Its white skin turned pink and he was no longer still born.

- At last Andrew heaved a sigh of relief. He handed the child

to the nurse. He told the entire story to Joe standing outside and walking down the street.

• The dawn was breaking by the time Andrew started towards home. He was full of gratitude towards god and felt a deep sense of satisfaction. He realized that he had done something real at last. It was the birth of his new life as a doctor.

MAIN POINTS:

BIRTH is the story of a doctor, just a fresher, who handles a complicated child delivery case in the most admirable way and brings back life in a dead born child.

Andrew Manson was returning home late night, brooding over a disappointing evening with his girlfriend, Christine. He reached home at midnight. Saw Joe Morgan awaiting him to attend to his wife Susan. She was expecting their first child after 20 years of marriage.

Susan was being looked after by her mother and a mid-wife. Both looked anxious and worried. Andrew was tired but patiently waited for the labor to begin.

After about an hour long harsh struggle a child was born towards dawn. But unfortunately it was still born. Andrew shivered with horror because he had promised the Morgans that everything would be alright.